

Saath Environmental Studies — Session 1

What is Sustainability? Small Actions, Big Impact

Duration	Session	Theme
60 minutes	Session 1	Sustainability & the 3Rs

Learning Objectives

- Understand what sustainability means
- Identify environmental problems around them
- Learn the 3Rs (Reduce, Reuse, Recycle)
- Commit to one sustainable habit

Lesson Flow

Time	Segment	What Happens
8 min	Icebreaker: “Good or Bad?”	Call out actions one at a time (throwing a plastic bottle, carrying a cloth bag, burning garbage, planting a tree, leaving the tap running). Students respond or and discuss briefly after each.
12 min	Core Teaching	What is the environment? What is sustainability (“using nature wisely so future generations can also use it”)? Introduce the 3Rs with daily-life examples (steel bottle vs. plastic, switching off fans/lights, reusing notebooks, cloth bags). Share one local example of an affected river, lake, or landfill. Keep it interactive with frequent questions.
25 min	Group Activity: “Trash Treasure Challenge”	Give each group newspaper, a plastic bottle, cardboard, an old box, bottle caps, and paper cups. Challenge: build something useful (pen stand, bird feeder, flower pot, pencil holder) in 15 minutes, then each group presents for 1 minute.
10 min	Reflection: “My Green Promise”	Each student writes one promise (e.g., “I will save water,” “I will use both sides of paper”) and sticks it on a chart titled “Saath Green Wall .”
5 min	Quick Recap Quiz	Ask: What is sustainability? Name the 3Rs. Why

		should we save water? Give one way to reduce plastic. What promise did you make today? Applaud correct answers.
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Materials Required

- Chart paper
- Sketch pens
- Waste materials (bottles, newspapers, cardboard, cups, bottle caps)
- Tape/glue
- Scissors (volunteer-handled if needed)

Homework (Optional)

Observe home habits for one week. Find three ways the family can save water, electricity, or reduce waste, and share one idea in the next session.